STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE	G-6216

	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 12/04/06	DATE REVISED **10/13/21**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		

CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES
SUBJECT FIREARMS SAFETY AND MAINTENANCE	CROSS REFERENCE P-3100 ROAD PATROL ROLL CALL

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for firearms safety and maintenance.

II. Policy:

The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office shall ensure the safety of all authorized weapons by conducting periodic inspections of all approved firearms carried by sworn personnel. Under no circumstances shall any firearm be modified or repaired without the approval of a Sheriff's Office Armorer. Repairs beyond the scope of Sheriff's Office armorers shall only be completed by the original manufacturer. Sworn personnel shall adhere to all guidelines regarding firearms safety.

III. Procedures:

A. Firearms Safety:

1. Deputies shall report to their immediate supervisor any use of prescription drugs or other medications they reasonably believe could impair their ability or judgment to use a firearm.

2. Deputies shall not carry or use any firearm while consuming any alcoholic beverages or while under the influence of alcohol or drugs.

3. Removal of firearms from their holsters or other carrying devices for other than authorized purposes is prohibited. Authorized purposes shall mean tactical use, training and qualification, inspection or cleaning, and maintenance. Any careless, reckless or casual use or display of a firearm shall constitute grounds for disciplinary action.

4. Deputies shall not store or leave a firearm in any place accessible to minors or individuals outside of law enforcement. Deputies are responsible for all privately owned and assigned firearms.

5. Trigger Locks: All deputies shall be issued a trigger lock device for their duty handguns.

a) Deputies are responsible for ensuring the lock is properly affixed to their duty handgun when it is out of their physical control.

b) Trigger locks shall only be applied to unloaded weapons to prevent an accidental discharge.

c) Once secured with a trigger lock, the firearm should be stored separate for the ammunition and inaccessible to unauthorized persons.

d) The key or combination for the trigger lock should be kept in a place not easily accessible to unauthorized persons.

6. Deputies may purchase a gun locker to store unattended weapons. Gun lockers shall be locked at all times with the key or combination kept separately from the locker (uniform allowance may be used for the purchase of a gun locker with a maximum lifetime reimbursement of $500.00).

7. Sheriff's Office personnel are encouraged to utilize trigger locks or a gun locker for all firearms, regardless whether the firearms are duty weapons or not.

8. All firearms shall be treated as if they are loaded. A firearm shall only be considered safe when:

a) There is no magazine in place and the firearm is completely unloaded.
b) The action is locked in the open position.
c) There is no visible round in the chamber.

9. All Sheriff's Office personnel are required to wear eye protection, hearing protection, and ballistic vests at all times while attending Sheriff's Office firearms training.

B. **Care and Maintenance of Firearms:** All Sheriff's Office approved firearms carried on duty shall be maintained in presentable (properly cleaned and lubricated) and functional (all parts in proper operating order and loaded with approved ammunition) condition at all times.

1. Cleaning: All firearms shall be cleaned in accordance with the manufacturer's instructions or instructions provided by an armorer.

a) All firearms shall be cleaned after each qualification prior to the deputy's next duty shift.

2. Inspection: Division commanders or their designees shall periodically inspect firearms carried on duty by deputies to ensure proper maintenance.

a) All issued and privately owned carbines carried for official use shall be inspected during each semi-automatic carbine qualification.

b) Duty handguns shall be inspected at each scheduled handgun qualification. Back-up handguns and off-duty handguns shall be inspected once per year at a predetermined handgun qualification.

c) Additional inspections shall be completed as directed by policy (see P-3100 Road Patrol Roll Call)

3. Loading and Unloading: Deputies shall fully understand the operation of any firearm prior to loading or unloading. When loading or unloading for an inspection, deputies shall have the firearms pointed into a charging barrel, when available, or in a safe direction.

4. Damaged or Defective Firearms: A Sheriff's Office approved firearm that is damaged or not functioning properly shall be reported immediately to an armorer.

a) Any repair work performed on a firearm shall be completed by a factory-authorized gunsmith, Sheriff's Office armorer or the original manufacturer.

b) Should a deputy's duty handgun be taken out of service for repairs, a replacement shall be furnished by the manufacturer or by the Training Sergeant.

c) No modifications or repairs of any kind to any approved firearm shall be made except under the direction of a Sheriff's Office armorer.

d) The Sheriff's Office assumes no liability for the maintenance, repair, or replacement of personally owned firearms except as necessary relative to on-duty incidents.